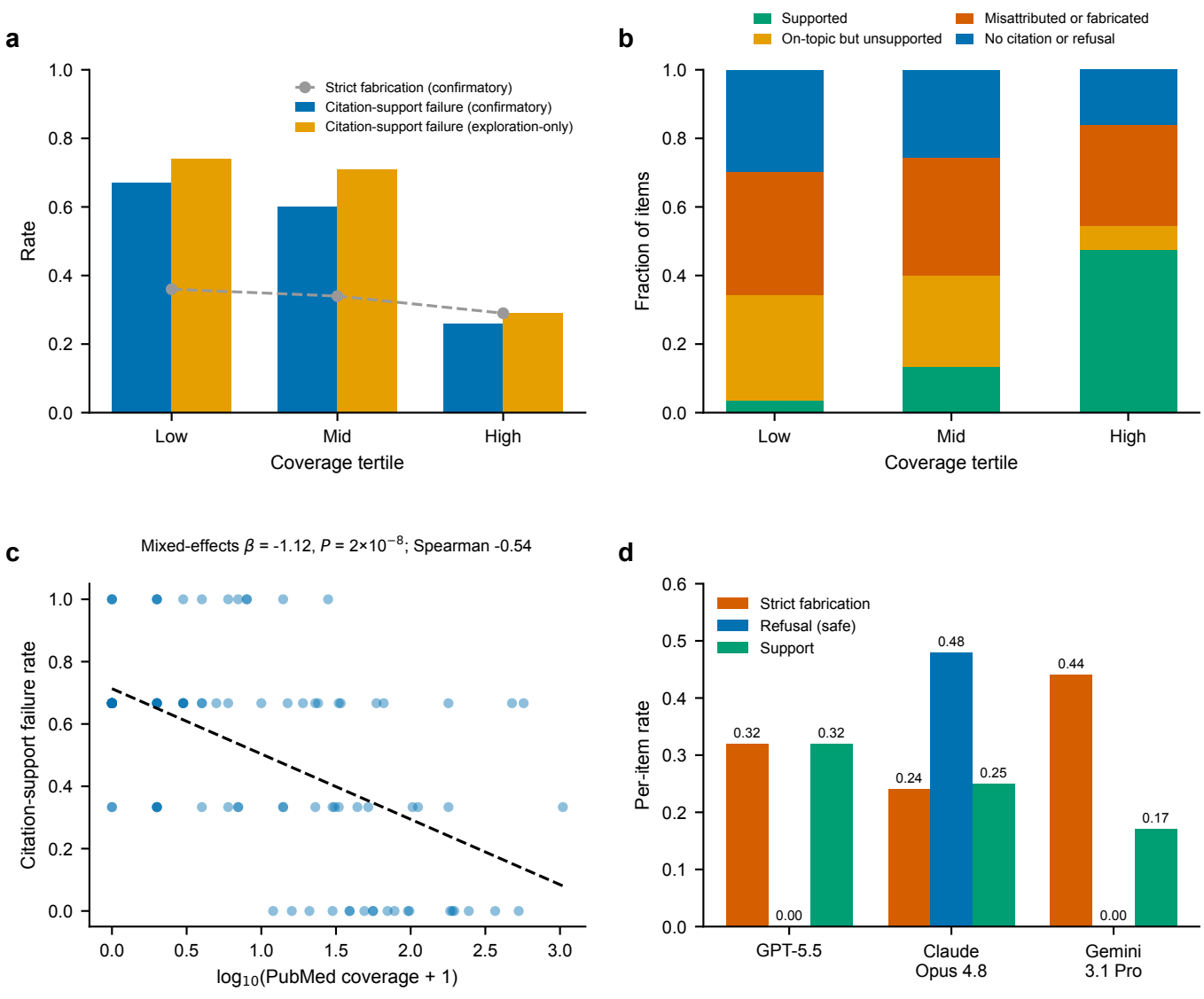

a
Strict fabrication (confirmatory)
Citation-support failure (confirmatory)
Citation-support failure (exploration-only)
Rate
1.0
0.8
0.6
0.4
0.2
0.0
Low
Mid
High
Coverage tertile
b
Supported
On-topic but unsupported
Misattributed or fabricated
No citation or refusal
Fraction of items
1.0
0.8
0.6
0.4
0.2
0.0
Low
Mid
High
Coverage tertile
c
Mixed-effects β = -1.12, P = 2×10−8; Spearman -0.54
Citation-support failure rate
1.0
0.8
0.6
0.4
0.2
0.0
0.0
0.5
1.0
1.5
2.0
2.5
3.0
log10(PubMed coverage + 1)
d
Strict fabrication
Refusal (safe)
Support
Per-item rate
0.6
0.5
0.4
0.3
0.2
0.1
0.0
0.32
0.00
0.32
0.24
0.48
0.25
0.44
0.00
0.17
GPT-5.5
Claude Opus 4.8
Gemini 3.1 Pro